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The AI Practitioner Conference

Enterprise AI Governance at Snowflake
Balancing Innovation & Risk

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Why AI Governance Is Different

AI Adoption Often Outpaces Governance Models

- AI tool adoption does not wait for review cycles
- Feature velocity outpaces traditional security processes
- AI blurs boundaries between endpoint, browser, cloud and SaaS
- Risk is no longer static - it is continuously evolving

New Reality: Governance must operate at AI velocity.

The Governance Backbone

Building a Cross-Functional AI Governance Team

Enterprise AI Steering Committee

- Security, Information Technology, Legal, Privacy, AI/ML & Data Engineering, Procurement

Executive Leadership

- Engineering, Product Management, Sales, Customer Experience, Information Technology, Legal

Shift: From reactive approvals → proactive risk ownership This became the control plane for enterprise AI decisions.

You Cannot Govern What You Cannot See

Establishing Enterprise Visibility into AI Usage

- Procurement rationalization for AI tools
- Feature gating authority for existing platforms
- Active discovery across endpoint, cloud, SaaS
- Business unit security partners for contextual awareness

Visibility precedes control.

Organizational Reality

Security Cannot Govern AI Alone

- Executive sponsorship required for tool or feature gating
- Shared risk ownership across Business units, Security, Legal, Privacy
- Developer trust is foundational to compliance
- Governance embedded into existing operating models

Lesson: Culture alignment is as critical as technical controls.

Enabling Responsible AI Adoption at Scale

Establish Enterprise Guardrails

- Endpoint, network, and DLP controls aligned to AI usage patterns

Legitimize What Adds Value

- Enterprise licenses for broadly used tools

Guide Toward Approved Alternatives

- Build awareness of sanctioned AI tools

Provide Controlled AI Experimentation

- Isolated environments (test tenants, synthetic data)
- Responsible AI experimentation framework

Secure Adoption of GenAI Tools

Phased deployment aligned to enterprise readiness

Enabled

- Core chat
- Tenant-contained collaboration
- Audited deployments
- Allow-listed custom GPTs

Gated

- Deep research (web)
- Expanded connected apps
- Autonomous execution features

Governing Coding Agents

Coding Agents Shift The Threat Model

- Rapid vendor release velocity
- Autonomous code execution
- System calls → RCE amplification risk
- Embedded browser components bypassing standard controls
- Configuration governance maturing
- Enterprise-grade controls continue to evolve

This is not “another dev tool.” It is a new execution layer inside the enterprise.

Our Governance Evaluation Process

Structured Assessment for Agentic Tools

- Assess execution surfaces (CLI, desktop)
- Evaluate enterprise risk impact
- Identify enterprise controls + vendor-native mitigations
- Assess developer workflow disruption
- Align on acceptable risk vs productivity

Goal: Secure enablement - not restriction.

Operationalizing Secure Enablement

Enterprise Guardrails Implemented

- Deployment constrained within enterprise tenant boundary
- Hardened configuration enforcement
- Secured manual & automated browser pathways
- Progressive restriction of high-autonomy execution modes
- Governance of approved integrations & capability surfaces
- Policy-aligned network egress oversight

Execution authority was bounded - not eliminated.

Governing AI at Enterprise Scale

What Enables AI to Scale Responsibly

- Executive Sponsorship Drives Alignment
- Shared Ownership Scales Better Than Central Control
- Visibility Informs Better Decisions
- Constrain Execution Authority — Not Innovation
- Governance Must Evolve at AI Velocity

AI governance is not a roadblock to innovation. It is the foundation that enables innovation to scale securely and responsibly.

Thanks

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